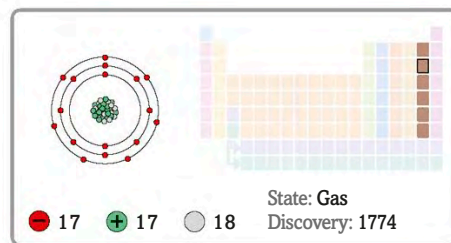


17

Cl

Chlorine



Forms



The skin of this tree frog contains a chlorine compound.

Red-eyed tree frog

This glass sphere traps pure chlorine so as to prevent any reactions with air.

Pure chlorine in a glass sphere

Pure chlorine is heavier than air.

Chlorine is named after the Greek word **chlōros**, which means “pale green”, a reference to the colour of this gaseous element. Chlorine is a highly reactive gas that forms a number of compounds, and does not exist pure in nature. The most common chlorine compound is sodium

chloride, found in nature as the mineral **halite**. Chlorine compounds are important for the body and are used by muscles and nerves. They are also present in sweat. As it is poisonous in its pure form, chlorine gas was used as a weapon during World War I: soldiers had to wear masks for protection